METRIC

A-A-20131B
May 1, 1998
SUPERSEDING
A-A-20131A
May 12, 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CHERRIES, MARASCHINO, PITTED, RED

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

1. SCOPE.

1.1 This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers pitted red maraschino cherries without stems, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by Federal, State, and local governments and other interested parties.

2. CLASSIFICATION.

2.1 Container size for the pitted red maraschino cherries shall be of the following container sizes as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Container sizes.

Container size I - 453.6 g (16 ounces) net weight
Container size II - 3,785.4 mL (128 fluid ounces)
Container size III - Other

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, Fruit and Vegetable Programs, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Ave., SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243 or telephone (202) 720-9939 or FAX (202) 690-0102.

FSC 8915

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2.2 **Product size:** The pitted red maraschino cherries shall be of the following sizes when specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Product size	Minimum diameter 1/	Maximum diameter 2/
Product Size A - Medium	18 mm	20 mm
Product Size B - Large	20 mm	22 mm
Product Size C - Extra large	22 mm	larger

1/ Not more than 10 percent, by weight, of all the cherries are smaller than the designated size; provided no more than 1 percent, by weight, are more than 2 mm smaller than the designated size.

2/ Not more than 10 percent, by weight, of all the cherries are larger than the designated size; provided no more than 1 percent, by weight, are more than 2 mm larger than the designated size.

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 **Processing:** The pitted red maraschino cherries shall be prepared from properly matured, sound, clean, whole cherries (**Prunus avium** or **Prunus cerasus**) which are properly bleached, pitted, and colored.

3.2 **Finished product:** The pitted red maraschino cherries shall be packed in a syrup solution and processed to insure preservation. The syrup at time of "cut out" (not earlier than 7 days after packing) shall not be less than 37° Brix at 20°C. Except for color, the pitted red maraschino cherries shall meet the requirements for U.S. Grade A, stemmed and pitted style, of the United States Standards for Grades of Sulfured Cherries.

3.3 **Flavor and odor:** The pitted red maraschino cherries shall have a distinct, characteristic maraschino cherry flavor and odor.

3.4 **Color:** The pitted red maraschino cherries shall have a uniform characteristic red maraschino cherry color. The red color shall be achieved by using any of the food colors currently certified and approved by the Food and Drug Administration.

3.5 **Flavoring ingredients:** Natural and/or artificial flavoring ingredients of the type and quantity used in the manufacture of pitted red maraschino cherries may be added. Calcium chloride, citric acid, potassium sorbate, and sodium benzoate may also be used.

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3.6 **Drained weight**: The minimum drained weight of the pitted red maraschino cherries shall be not less than the following:

Container size	Minimum drained weight
453.6 g (16 ounces) net weight	269.3 g (9.5 ounces)
3,785.4 mL (128 fluid ounces)	2,551.5 g (5 pounds, 10 ounces)

The drained weight of the pitted red maraschino cherries shall be determined by emptying the contents of the container on an 8-inch or 12-inch diameter U.S. Standard No. 8 sieve, allowing the sieve to drain for 2 minutes in an inclined position at a 17° to 20° angle, and calculating the weight of the cherries by subtracting the weight of the dry sieve.

3.7 **Age requirement**: Unless otherwise specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase, order, the pitted red maraschino shall be prepared from the latest year crop, and shall be processed and packaged less than one year prior to purchase by the Government.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

3.1 The delivered pitted red maraschino cherries shall comply with all applicable Federal, State, and local mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sale of the pitted red maraschino cherries in the commercial marketplace. Delivered pitted red maraschino cherries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

4.1 **Product conformance**. The pitted red maraschino cherries provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this CID, conform to the producer's own specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same pitted red maraschino cherries offered for sale in the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

4.2 **Quality assurance**. When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order that product quality or acceptability or both be determined, the Processed Products Branch (PPB), Fruit and Vegetable Programs, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture shall be the certifying activity and shall make the determination in accordance with applicable PPB procedures. The pitted red maraschino cherries shall be examined or analyzed or both in accordance with applicable provisions in the CID, solicitation, contract, or purchase order, and, when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers in effect on the date of the solicitation.

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5. PACKAGING.

5.1 **Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking.** Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking shall be as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

6. NOTES.

6.1 **Purchasers shall specify:**

- Container size(s).
- Product size(s).

6.2 **Sources of documents.**

6.2.1 **Source of information for nongovernmental document is as follows:**

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International may be obtained from: **AOAC International, 481 North Frederick Avenue, Suite 500, Gaithersburg, MD 20877.**

6.2.2 **Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:**

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. This document may be purchased from: **Superintendent of Documents, ATTN: New Orders, P.O. Box 371954, Pittsburgh, PA 15250-7954.** Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 512-1800.

Copies of the United States Standards for Grades of Sulfured Cherries are available from: **Chief, Processed Products Branch, STOP 0247, 1400 Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250-0247.**

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from: **Chairperson, Condition of Container Committee, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243.**

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from: **General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Specifications Section, Suite 8100, 470 East L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407.**

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Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to: **Standardization Documents Order Desk, Defense Automation Printing Service, 700 Robbins Avenue, Building 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.**

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 35

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - NIH, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - FV

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